I Will Be Back, Will You Spend?

An Emotional Perspective on Alliance Burden-Sharing

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Agendas

1. Research motivation/Introduction
2. Literature review
3. Theoretical framework
4. The Transatlantic Rhetoric Dataset
5. Methodology
6. Results & Discussion
7. Conclusion & Implications
8. Q & A

Introduction

Introduction & Research Motivation

- Trump, Greenland, NATO
- From 2% to 5%
- Leaders, emotions, and dynamics
- RQ: What are the effects of emotions on allies behavior?

Literature review

Who leads, who feels, and who pays

Who leads

- Leading state as a state that has not become a regional hegemon and has no extensive military capabilities
- Leading state lead in cooperations/alliances
- But, no leaders >>> individual level of analysis matters

Who feels

- Functions of emotions
  - Communication
  - Sense-making
  - Mobilization
  - Discipline (“name and shame”)
- State emotions vs. individual emotions
- Individual emotions >>> collective emotions >>> state emotions
- Koschut (2014): emotional security community

Who pays

- States with higher GDP
- States with higher economic capacities
- United Stats, Germany, France, etc. have been carrying the weight
- Shifts in the burden-sharing structure
  - Diverging interests
  - Intra-alliance security competition

Theoretical framework

Leaders, Emotions, and Alliance Dynamics

- Strategic emotions
  - Defined as **meticulously and deliberately constructed means of communication to instigate specific reactions, responses, and/or behaviors for specific political purposes**
  - Natural emotions = strategic emotions: leaders transform their own emotions into collective emotions >>> 9/11
  - Natural emotions ≠ strategic emotions: leaders hide hypocrisy >>> Iraq
- Alliance dynamics
  - Natural emotions = strategic emotions: amity >>> unity/common position
  - Natural emotions ≠ strategic emotions: enmity or fracture within the alliance due to lack of common position and interests

Specific Emotions

Emotions	Effects	Reason
Anger	Negative	Diplomatic temper tantrum
Fear	Negative	Uncertainty
Joy	Positive	Encouraging, shows satisfaction
Sadness	Negative	Lack of confidence
Disgust	Negative	Display of enmity
Surprise	Negative	External shock

Transatlantic Emotions Dataset

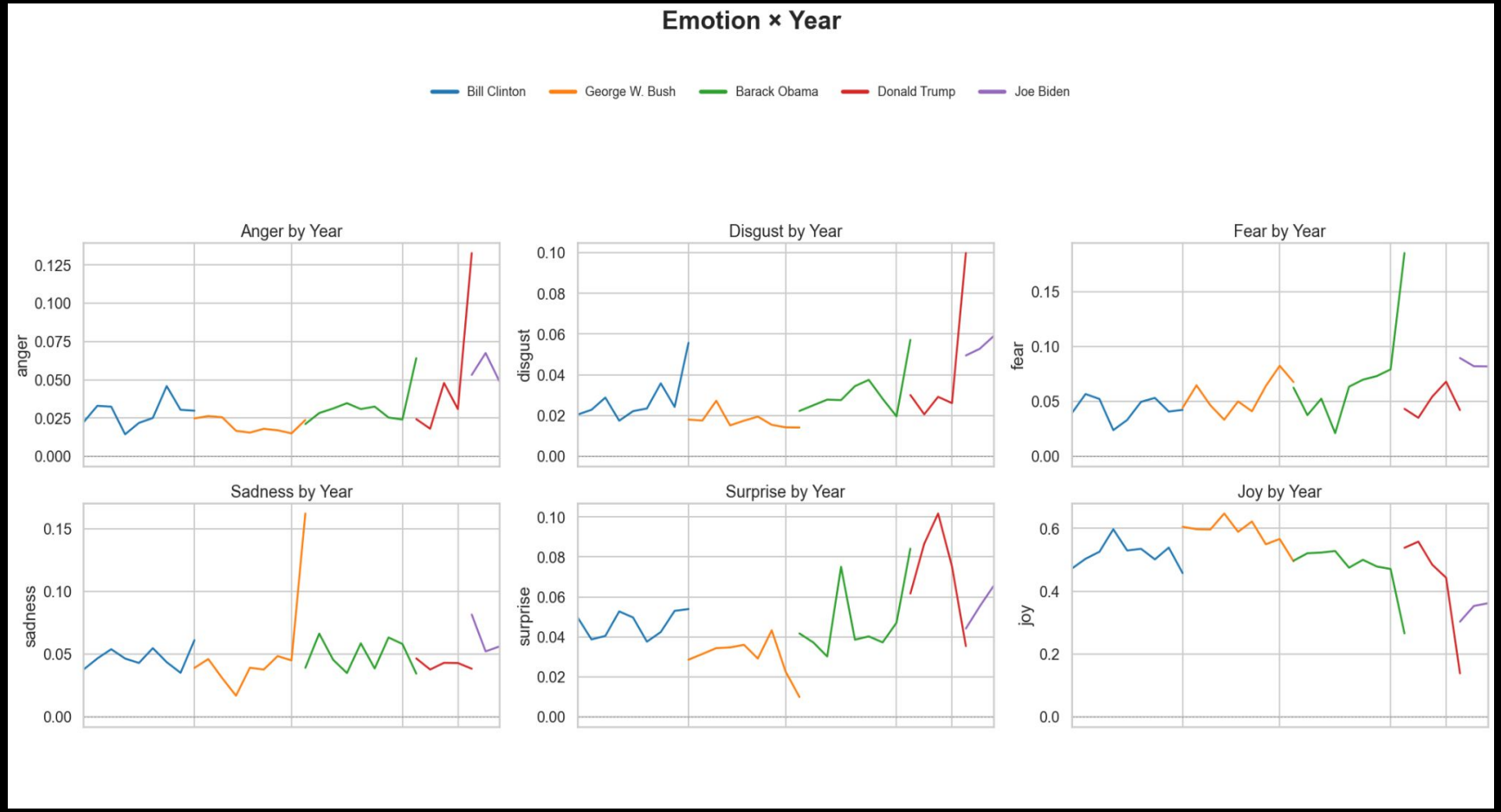
Data

- 29 NATO allies (excluding Iceland and Sweden)
- Period: 1993 - 2023
- Panel-data structure
- N = 8,137 NATO related presidential speeches
- DV: RDef
- IV: emotions (annual average)
- Controls
  - Sentiment
  - Level of Democracy
  - Intrastate Conflicts

Methodology

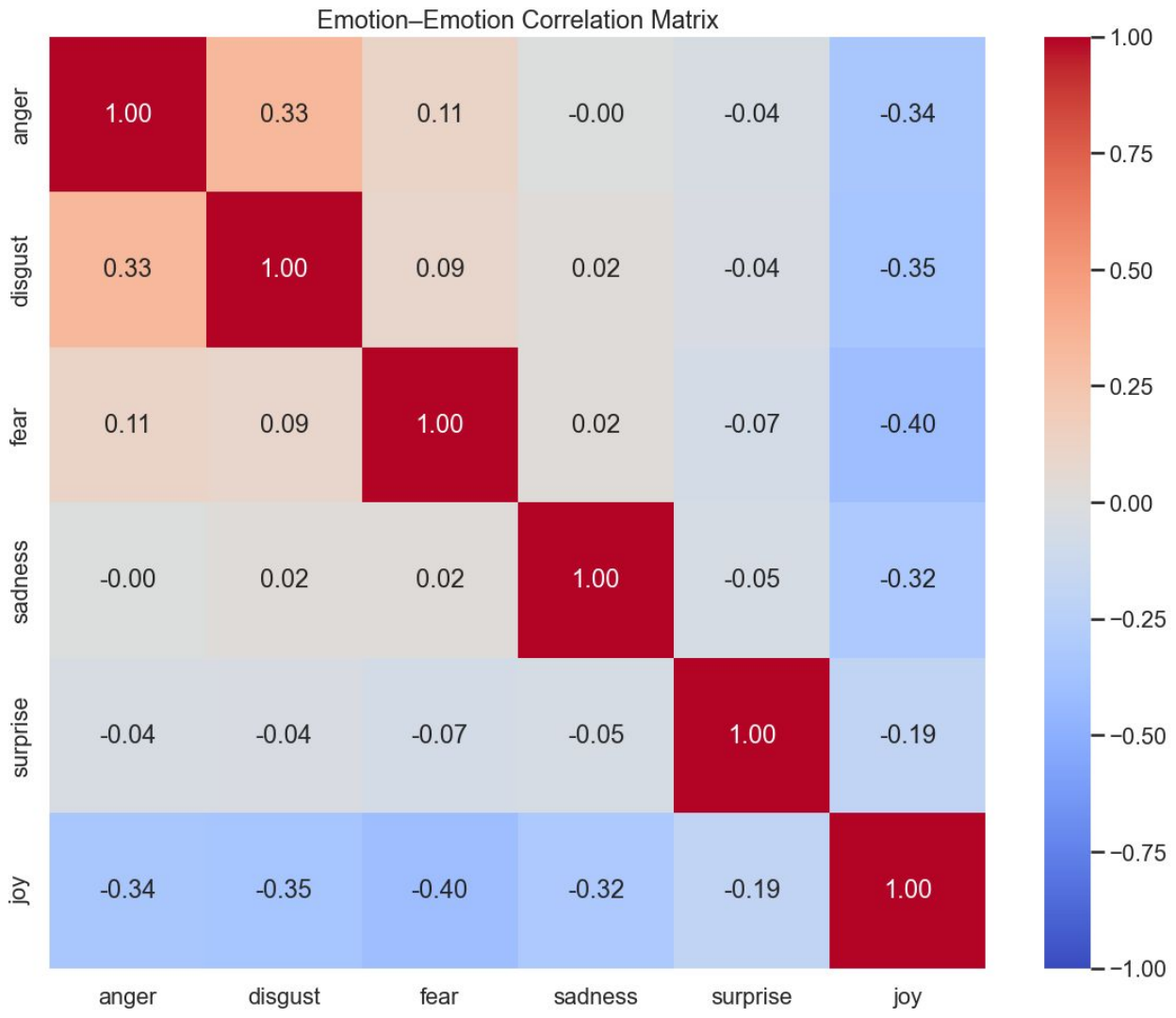
Methods

- Unsupervised machine learning
- Two large language models
  - For IVs: DistilBERT (a more precise version of RoBERTa) >>> various aspects in the same text
  - For sentiment: BART Large MNLI (BART) model >>> general “tone”
- Four models
  - Raw Analysis
  - The European Model (EU = 1)
  - The Democratic Model (party = “Democrats”)
  - The Republican Model (party = “Republican”)


Emotion × Year
Bill Clinton
George W. Bush
Barack Obama
Donald Trump
Joe Biden
Anger by Year
anger
0.125
0.100
0.075
0.050
0.025
0.000
Disgust by Year
disgust
0.10
0.08
0.06
0.04
0.02
0.00
Fear by Year
fear
0.15
0.10
0.05
0.00
Sadness by Year
sadness
0.15
0.10
0.05
0.00
Surprise by Year
surprise
0.10
0.08
0.06
0.04
0.02
0.00
Joy by Year
joy
0.6
0.4
0.2
0.0

Results & Discussion

Correlation Matrix



Main Findings

- Anger has a positive effects on defense spending
  - potential appeasement behavior
  - Cares about reputation
- Democratic presidents are more effective than Republican presidents
- Anger, fear, and sadness are consistently significant across the models, regardless of country-fixed effects and control variables

Alternative Explanations

- Fiscal Rule Index:
  - no significance
- Proximity
  - Log transformation
  - Negative correlation
  - Significant

Conclusion & Implications

Conclusion, Implications, Limitations

- Emotions can influence allies behavior regarding collective security.
- Emotions are strategic.
- Some emotions do matter more: anger, fear, and sadness.
- Implications: states/leaders can securitize emotions (future research).
- Limitations
  - No pre-Cold War analysis
  - Only five presidents (3 Democrats + two Republicans) >>> uneven sample size
  - European = EU members, not by geographical locations

Q & A